

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Analyst | Microsoft Sentinel | KQL | Threat Detection | Incident Response

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified Senior Cyber Security Analyst with over five years of hands-on experience in Security Operations Centre (SOC) operations, threat detection, and full-lifecycle incident response. I have expert-level proficiency in Microsoft Sentinel and Kusto Query Language (KQL), covering workspace design, analytics rule development, data connector configuration, and automated Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks. I am experienced with CrowdStrike Falcon as a combined Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and Next-Generation Security Information and Event Management (NG-SIEM) platform, and I have working experience with Splunk/SPL for log analysis and investigation. I specialise in developing and tuning detection logic aligned to MITRE ATT&CK Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures (TTPs), conducting proactive threat hunting, and leading incident response as senior escalation point in line with NIST 800-61. I have managed large-scale Microsoft security deployments including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, and Microsoft Entra ID across an 8,000-user estate. I am looking to apply my detection engineering and threat analysis expertise to a senior analyst role where I can drive improvements in threat detection maturity, reduce dwell time, and mentor less experienced analysts.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Platforms:** Microsoft Sentinel (workspace design, data connectors, KQL analytics rules, workbooks, incident management); CrowdStrike NG-SIEM; Splunk/SPL log analysis and search
- **Kusto Query Language (KQL):** Custom detection rule development, threat hunting queries, investigation workflows, and scheduled analytics in Microsoft Sentinel
- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover) - expert deployment and threat hunting; Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **Threat Detection and Hunting:** MITRE ATT&CK-mapped detection logic; proactive threat hunting across SIEM, EDR, and cloud environments; detection tuning and false-positive reduction
- **Incident Response:** Senior escalation lead; NIST 800-61-aligned; full incident lifecycle from triage through to post-incident review and lessons learned; playbook authoring and continuous improvement
- **Microsoft Defender Stack:** MDE, MDI, Microsoft 365 Defender; 8,000-user enterprise deployment and policy management
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID (Azure Active Directory); Conditional Access; Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA); Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **SOAR Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks; SOAR workflow design and PowerShell scripting for automated response and enrichment
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Nessus; risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Email and Endpoint Security:** Mimecast email security gateway; Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM; least-privilege access and credential governance
- **Compliance Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, JISC, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Own the **Microsoft Sentinel** SIEM platform end-to-end: design and maintain the workspace architecture, configure data connectors across cloud and on-premises log sources, develop custom **KQL** analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, and build automated SOAR playbooks for incident enrichment and response.

- Lead **threat hunting** operations using CrowdStrike Falcon and Sentinel KQL queries to proactively identify indicators of compromise, novel attack patterns, and post-compromise activity not yet triggering automated detections.
- Serve as **senior escalation lead** for the security operations function: triage, investigate, and lead response to high-severity incidents in line with NIST 800-61, coordinating containment, eradication, and post-incident review.
- Operate **CrowdStrike Falcon** (EDR, Prevent, NG-SIEM, Insight, Discover) as primary SME: manage detection policies, tune alert thresholds, develop threat hunting queries, and maintain platform health.
- Manage and improve **detection engineering** across the SIEM and EDR stack: iteratively refine detection rules, reduce false positives, and expand coverage for emerging attacker techniques.
- Administer **Microsoft Defender** (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across 8,000 users; manage investigation workflows, configure alert policies, and coordinate response actions.
- Use **Splunk** and CrowdStrike for log analysis, search, and correlation during complex threat investigations requiring multi-source data analysis.
- Manage **Microsoft Entra ID**, Conditional Access, and MFA; respond to identity-based threats including credential-based attacks and account compromise events.
- Lead **vulnerability management** using Tenable.io, AppCheck, and Pentera BAS; prioritise findings by risk, coordinate remediation, and report status to leadership.
- Develop and maintain incident response playbooks, threat hunting runbooks, and SOC operational documentation.
- Mentor junior security analysts; provide guidance on investigation techniques, tool usage, and MITRE ATT&CK-based analysis.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 – March 2025

- Performed Tier 2/3 SOC analyst duties across **Microsoft Sentinel** and **CrowdStrike Falcon**: alert triage, investigation, threat detection, and escalation for incidents across endpoint, identity, email, and cloud environments.
- Developed and tuned **KQL** detection rules and correlation queries in Microsoft Sentinel, improving detection coverage and reducing alert fatigue.
- Conducted threat hunting across SIEM and EDR data sources using MITRE ATT&CK-mapped hypotheses to proactively identify undetected threats.
- Responded to and investigated security incidents including phishing campaigns, malware execution, account compromise, and insider threat scenarios.
- Managed Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Group Policy, and MFA for a multi-site user estate.
- Conducted vulnerability scanning using Nessus and AppCheck; tracked remediation progress with asset owners.
- Contributed to SOAR playbook development, automating alert enrichment and initial response actions within Microsoft Sentinel.
- Administered Mimecast email security; supported security awareness training and phishing simulation programmes.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 – March 2022

- Implemented and maintained security monitoring, endpoint protection, and access controls across a SaaS/FinTech environment.
- Conducted log analysis and security event investigation to identify and respond to threats across the IT infrastructure.
- Managed identity and access controls, patch management, and vulnerability remediation in line with ISO 27001.
- Supported network security operations and contributed to security documentation, policies, and risk assessments.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a full **Microsoft Sentinel** SIEM workspace from greenfield, including 20+ data connectors, custom KQL analytics rules, automated SOAR playbooks, and executive workbooks, significantly improving threat detection maturity.
- Built and operationalised a hybrid **SOC** capability combining CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM and Microsoft Sentinel for unified detection and response across cloud and on-premises environments.
- Deployed **Microsoft Defender** (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across an 8,000-user estate, expanding threat detection coverage across endpoint, identity, and email attack surfaces.
- Delivered measurable reduction in **mean time to detect (MTTD)** and **mean time to respond (MTTR)** through detection engineering improvements and SOAR automation in Microsoft Sentinel.
- Authored a comprehensive library of **incident response playbooks** and threat hunting runbooks, establishing consistent and repeatable SOC processes.
- Maintained **Cyber Essentials Plus** accreditation; led technical control validation across patching, access control, malware protection, and firewall domains.

EDUCATION

- **M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering**
- **B.Sc. Chemical Engineering**

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 75,000–85,000 | Hybrid (UK)